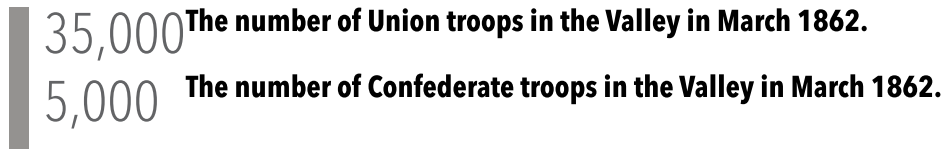


intelligence. The latter derived both from cooperation on the part of the local population, who gave Jackson information about enemy movements, and from the work of staff cartographer Jedediah Hotchkiss, who made accurate maps of the Valley.



The Shenandoah Valley

The Valley was important to Confederate armies as it offered a strategic route to attack Washington, Maryland, and Pennsylvania. It also became an important source of food for the Confederacy.

Confederate numbers bolstered

Backed by Robert E. Lee, then President Davis's military adviser, Jackson was reinforced by the dispatch of a division under Major General Richard S. Ewell. Jackson and Ewell proved effective partners, both thoroughly eccentric men but fierce fighting generals.

By mid-April, Jackson was on the move again. He utterly confused his enemy by crossing the Blue Ridge Mountains toward Richmond, only to return by train to Staunton at the southern end of the Valley. He then struck westward, where a Union army under Major General John C. Frémont was trying to push through the mountains of western Virginia into east Tennessee. Jackson's men defeated Frémont's advanced guard at the hamlet of McDowell on May 8, which alerted Union General Nathaniel Banks to expect trouble. He took up a position across the main road at Strasburg, but Jackson and Ewell marched hard and fast around his flank. They defeated a small Union force at Front Royal on May 22 and